Group Definition and Characteristics in Workplace Behaviour

MB333A Workplace Behaviour – Unit 4

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What Is a Group?

Definitions and Distinctions

S.P. ROBBINS

Definition

Two or more individuals, interacting and interdependent, who have come together to achieve particular objectives.

EDGAR SCHEIN

Definition

A group consists of people who interact, are psychologically aware of one another, and perceive themselves as a single unit.

NOT A GROUP

Crowd or Queue

A crowd or queue is merely an aggregate of people without interaction or shared identity; not a true group.

Core Characteristics of Groups

Common Goals	Members share a mutual purpose or target.
Interaction and Interdependence	Members communicate and rely on each other’s work.
Roles and Norms	Defined duties and shared rules guide behavior.
Identity and Cohesiveness	A sense of “we” feeling, unity, and bonding.



Why Do People Join Groups?

Security

Groups reduce feelings of isolation and provide safety in numbers.

Status and Self-Esteem

Being part of a recognized group boosts social prestige and confidence.

Affiliation

Groups satisfy our need for friendship and a sense of belonging.

Power and Goal Achievement

Many goals can be achieved more effectively through collective effort.



Case Study

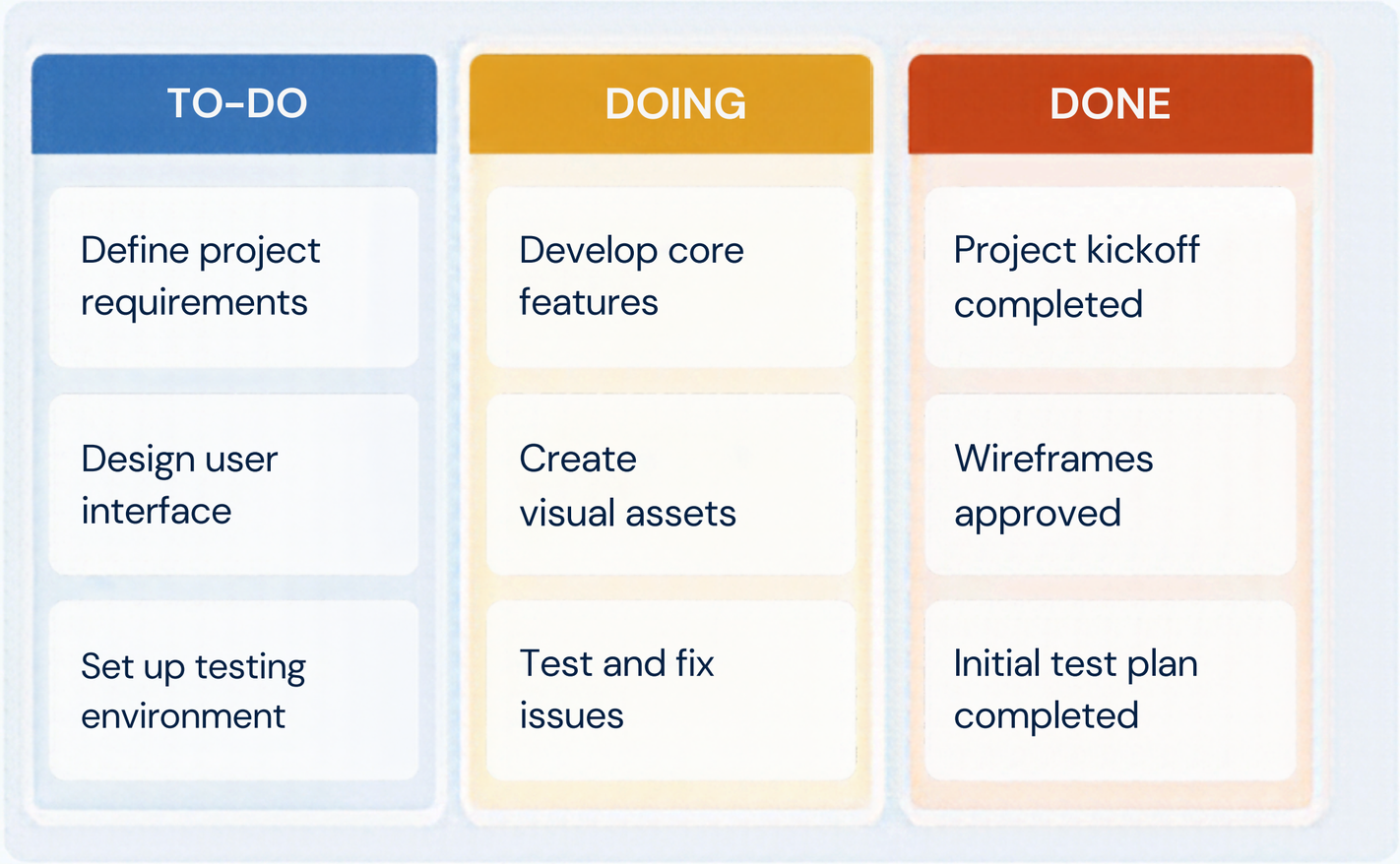
Workplace Project Team

A four-member software or marketing team working under a **tight deadline**.

Progress is tracked on an **agile board** with To-Do, Doing, and Done.

Regular coordination meetings keep everyone **aligned and on track**.

Success comes from **cooperation, shared responsibility, and clear communication**.



Summary and Takeaways

Key Points to Remember

Groups are fundamental building blocks of workplace behaviour.

True groups require interaction, shared goals, and interdependence.

Effective groups foster identity, roles, norms, and cooperation.

Strong groups drive workplace success through collaboration and shared purpose.



References

MB333A Workplace Behaviour Unit 4 course materials

Organizational behaviour literature, especially S.P. Robbins

Additional relevant textbooks and academic sources

Other scholarly articles and industry insights as applicable

